

Essential Business Deliverable #3: Customer Segmentation, Competitive Matrix, and Market Ecosystem

Customer Segmentation:

Identify the 1, 2, or 3 most important Customer Segments for your product, based on your interviews. Customer Segments are titles of people, who share the same buying behaviors and are relevant to the same value propositions. If you have several kinds of customers, prioritize the one that will be your initial focus. Identify the size of each customer segment (number of customers and potential revenue, within a given geographic scope and time period.)

1. Multifamily Property Managers & Operators (Primary Market)

- Who they are: Property Managers, Operations Directors, Regional Asset Managers responsible for large multifamily and hotel buildings.
- What drives them: Rising utility costs (20–25% annually) directly erode NOI. They need plug-and-play solutions that deliver clear savings, protect tenant comfort, and provide transparent reporting for owners and investors.
- Market size (U.S.): ~700,000 multifamily and hotel buildings over 50,000 sq ft.
- Average contract value (ACV): ~\$10K per building per year.
- Revenue opportunity (full market): \$7B ARR.

2. Industrial Warehouse Tenants / 3PL Operators (Secondary Market)

- Who they are: Facilities Directors, Warehouse Operations Managers, Energy Managers at 3PLs and logistics firms operating high-load warehouses.
- What drives them: They directly pay utility bills under NNN leases, with costs rising from EV fleets, forklifts, and automation. They are highly ROI-driven and adopt solutions that reduce costs while ensuring reliability.
- Market size (U.S.): ~700,000 industrial warehouse buildings.
- Average contract value (ACV): ~\$20K per building per year.
- Revenue opportunity (full market): \$14B ARR.

Retail Strip Centers (Tertiary Market)

- Who they are: Property Managers, Facility Directors, and Small Portfolio Owners managing multi-tenant retail strips.
- What drives them: Similar to multifamily — utility cost pressures, limited staff capacity, and the need to attract/retain tenants. They want automation that simplifies operations and boosts NOI.
- Market size (U.S.): ~115,000 retail strip centers.
- Average contract value (ACV): ~\$15K per building per year.
- Revenue opportunity (full market): \$1.7B ARR.

Customer Archetype:

Picking your most important Customer Segment, write 5-10 sentences identifying a typical customer's wants, needs, and perspective of the world. Give them a name, a title, even a company name, as if you are creating an imaginary friend. Your customer must be a person, not an entity like a corporation. Explain how they make decisions, who influences them, what resources they have available, how their job success relates to your product.

Example: "Blair Smith is a senior psychology major at UMass with a full course load working to maintain her B average while working 20 hours a week as a waitress, and frantically looking for a "real" job for when she graduates in a few months. She has what feels like a mountain of student debt to worry about, as well as a dorm room overflowing with four years of acquired junk. She has no storage space close by and couldn't afford to pay for it even if it were available." ([source](#) with more examples)

Name: Jared Shoemaker

Title: Property Manager at GF Properties

Location: Denver, CO

Portfolio: 2.4 million sq ft across 30 commercial properties

Meet Jared, a 42-year-old Property Manager for GF Properties, overseeing a portfolio of multifamily buildings in Denver averaging 75,000 sq ft each. Jared spends most of his week juggling tenant complaints, maintenance issues, and rising operating costs. Utilities have become his second-largest headache after labor; he's watched energy bills climb 20% year-over-year, eroding the NOI his bosses use to measure his performance.

Jared doesn't have the time or staff to micromanage HVAC schedules or lighting systems. His team is lean, and most fixes are reactive waiting for bills or tenant complaints before action. What he wants is a tool that quietly manages energy in the background, keeps tenants comfortable, and surfaces clear numbers he can hand to ownership to justify investments.

He makes decisions cautiously, needing proof of ROI within 3–5 years. His regional asset manager has final approval on large capital expenses, but Jared's voice carries weight because he knows the buildings day-to-day. He's wary of complex systems that require training or IT support, since his staff aren't engineers. His success is judged on tenant retention, operating cost control, and the reports he delivers to owners, all areas where SPARK's IEH directly supports him.

From Jared's perspective, technology is useful only if it saves him money and time without introducing new risks. If SPARK can help him reduce utility bills, improve NOI, and make his properties more competitive, he becomes a champion because it actively looking for solutions that can end his crisis and give him tools to manage his costs.

Competitive Matrix:

You should add to or modify the factors in the chart to reflect the most important characteristics of your product / service / technology.

FACTOR	SPARK (My Business)	STRENGTH	WEAKNESS	SPAN	PassiveLogic	GridPoint	Importance to Customer
Products	Intelligent Energy Hub (IEH): AI-enabled panel interface	Real-time decision logic and control	Still in prototype phase	Smart panel with controls	Building automation logic engine	Monitoring + HVAC scheduling	5 – Essential
Price	<\$10K installed + \$250–\$500/month SaaS	Affordable vs. BMS systems	Pricing model still being refined	\$5K–\$15K+ depending on install	Custom-priced + longer integration cycles	Subscription + service fee	4 – Important
Quality	Circuit-level monitoring + intelligent coordination	Transparent, high-resolution	Installation-dependent accuracy	Mature hardware, evolving UI	Promising intelligence, not field-proven	Proven across retail sites	5 – Essential
Selection	Modular hub with single SKU	Simplified install and expansion	Limited device range today	Various panel types	Custom systems	Pre-defined bundles	3 – Moderate
Service	Hybrid: direct support + certified installer partners	Flexible, partner-ready	Early-stage national support	Electrician and installer partners	Full-stack + field service	High-touch for enterprise	4 – Important
Reliability	Robust hardware + AI tuning	Plug-and-play by design	Limited field data so far	Field-tested	Still scaling	High uptime across clients	5 – Essential
Stability	Agile startup with technical validation	Early traction with grants and pilots	Still raising capital	Well-funded and scaling	Deep R&D focus	Mature and revenue-backed	5 – Essential
Expertise	Deep energy + software domain experience	Strong innovation team	Limited full-stack scale today	Electrical hardware core	Advanced software AI	HVAC + enterprise integration	4 – Important
Company Reputation	Mission-driven, early-stage, DOR & CTO-validated	Trusted pilot partners	Not yet broadly known	Industry credibility	High-profile media, but slow to scale	Strong among commercial chains	4 – Important
Location	Based in Denver	Close to pilot customers	Limited national presence today	U.S.-wide operations	Utah HQ	National offices	2 – Low
Appearance	Intuitive dashboard + clean industrial design	Focused on user clarity	Brand early in development	Premium product aesthetic	Futuristic interface	Functional interface	3 – Moderate

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<i>Sales Method</i>	Direct and channel sales + partners	Aligned with facilities workflows	Still building go-to-market	Partner-heavy	Enterprise direct sales	Utilities + B2B sales	5 – Essential
<i>Credit Policies</i>	TBD – early stage	Flexible for pilot phase	No leasing options yet	Financing via partners	Unknown	Offers commercial leasing/finance	3 – Moderate
<i>Advertising</i>	Targeted industry outreach + referrals	Founder-led storytelling	Low brand awareness	Paid + PR	Event-led	Industry marketing	2 – Low
<i>Image</i>	Future-facing, system-level intelligence layer	Visionary + practical	Needs broader visibility	Consumer-driven energy product	Bold R&D identity	Conservative enterprise player	5 – Essential

Market Ecosystem:



- **Customers / Buyers:**
 - Facilities Directors
 - Property Managers
 - Asset/Portfolio Managers
- **Influencers:**
 - Energy consultants
 - Tenant experience managers
 - Utility DR program managers
- **Channels / Partners:**
 - Commercial electrical contractors
 - Energy service companies (ESCOs)
 - Smart building consultants
 - Utility aggregators
- **Competitors / Substitutes:**
 - SPAN

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- PassiveLogic
- GridPoint
- Building automation systems (BAS)
- Manual audits or status quo inertia
- **Enablers:**
 - ARPA-E and DOE funding programs
 - Tax incentives for DER readiness
 - Local government electrification mandates
 - Real estate ESG performance frameworks